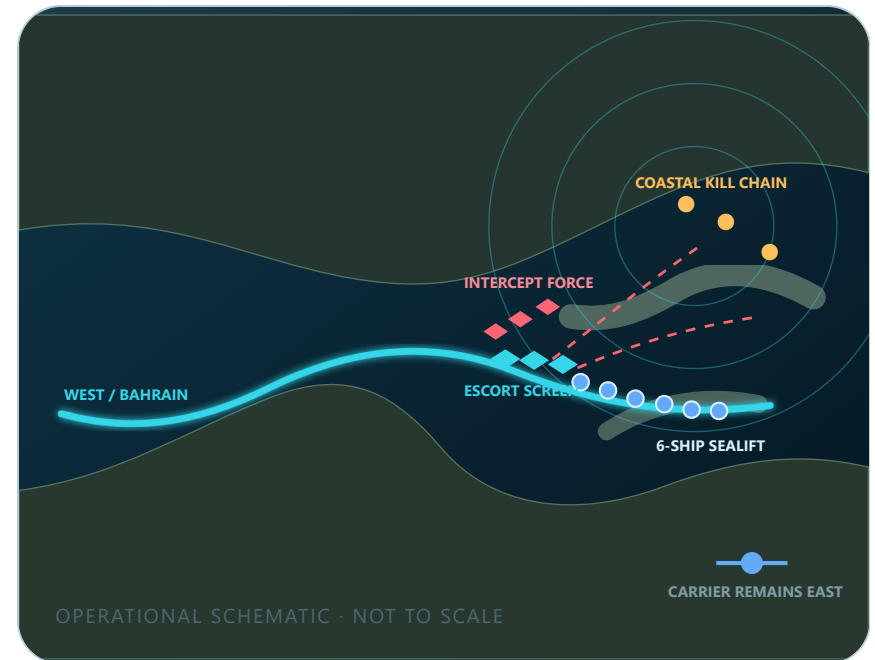


COMMANDER'S PLANNING PACKET • CAMPAIGN TURN 5

Operation Resolute Passage

A naval-centric command brief for reopening the Strait of Hormuz and escorting six high-value auxiliaries west before Bahrain's missile-defense, aviation-fuel, repair, and medical stocks fall below contingency levels.

Real-coastline audit - clean



50

BLUE ASSETS

24

RED ASSETS

50%

MINIMUM CONVOY SURVIVAL

5 HOURS

KILL-CHAIN DISRUPTION REQUIRED

Reopen the corridor without widening the war.

Intent statement. The coalition will exploit the temporary control gained during Silver Current to escort the bulk sustainment package west through Hormuz. We will preserve the logistics backbone by detecting and defeating the Iranian surface-air attack at standoff range, disrupting the designated coastal kill chain under positive control, and retaining a recoverable combat force. Success is a functioning corridor and a sustained forward force in Bahrain—not destruction for its own sake.

EXPANDED PURPOSE

Prevent Bahrain's forward naval and air-defense posture from falling below contingency readiness. Airlift cannot deliver the required bulk fuel, VLS reloads, repair modules, and medical stores in time.

KEY TASKS

- Maintain a recognized maritime and air picture from assembly through western exit.
- Keep at least five of six auxiliaries mission capable.
- Lead with MCM assets and keep high-value units behind layered air defense.
- Destroy at least six of nine hostile surface combatants from outside FAC gun range.
- Neutralize at least three designated coastal kill-chain nodes.
- Preserve carrier and land-based recovery options; retain a credible post-mission screen.

END STATE

- Five or more auxiliaries clear the decisive Strait sector westbound.
- Iranian surface interception is combat ineffective.
- At least three sensor/missile nodes are neutralized.
- BLUE can recover aircraft and continue escort operations.
- No attacks occur outside designated hostile forces and sites.

1

Protect the campaign's sustainment center of gravity.

2

Break the most dangerous massed salvo.

3

Never trade inside the FAC gun envelope.

4

Strike only positively controlled designated nodes.

5

Finish with recovery and follow-on capacity.

The mission viewed through the maritime fight.

M

Mission

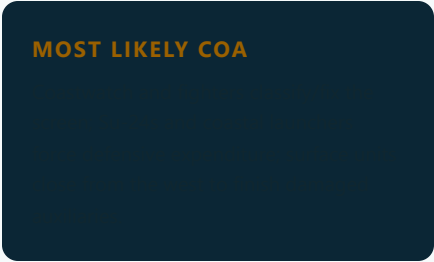
Escort six auxiliaries west through the Hormuz corridor while defeating the forces that can close it. Protect five, destroy six hostile surface combatants, and neutralize three coastal nodes.

Decisive operation: protected convoy passage. Surface and shore strikes are shaping or supporting actions unless they directly threaten the convoy.

E

Enemy

24 assets: five Kaman FACs, two Moudge frigates, two Tsunami missile boats, three Bastions, three Pantsirs, one S-300, Coastwatch radar, Bandar Abbas strip, four MiG-29s, and two Su-24Ms.



T

Terrain & Weather

The narrow Strait compresses formations and weapon axes. Peninsula and island geometry creates radar shadow, late visual contacts, and channelization. Open water east and west favors long-range sensing and missile employment.

Scenario conditions: 1400 local, sea state 3. Specific visibility, wind, and merchant density are not modeled; treat them as commander’s assumptions rather than known facts.

T

Troops & Support Available

Six auxiliaries; five major AAW combatants; Type 23, Cyclone, and cutter close screen; two MCMs; offshore carrier; Al Dhafra; eight fighters/strike aircraft; two P-8s; E-2D; KC-135R.

Constraint: player-controlled aircraft lose automatic attack tasking at game start. CAP and shore strike require deliberate player control and target assignment.



Time Available

The campaign premise gives less than twenty-four hours before Bahrain's contingency stocks become operationally limiting. The tactical matrix is event-driven: phase on classification, salvo defeat, and geographic clearance rather than arbitrary clock time.

There is no formal in-game TimeGoal. The time pressure is operational context and a group pacing mechanism.



Civil Considerations

Hormuz is an international commercial chokepoint bordered by populated coasts. Maintain positive identification, avoid neutral shipping lanes where possible, and confine shore attack to the five designated nodes.

For Discord play, publish one command net, one air-control net, a shared target-status format, and a clear pause/clarification procedure before launch.



Risk to Mission / Risk to Force

Primary risk: convoy compression during a coordinated saturation attack. **Control:** do not outrun the MCM lead, maintain AAW depth, keep auxiliaries outside direct-fire range, and prioritize inbound weapons and shooters over opportunistic targets. **Residual risk:** one auxiliary may be lost without mission failure, but loss of two breaks Commander's Intent.

Read water, airspace, coastline, and sensors as one terrain system.



Observation & Fields of Fire

- Sentinel and P-8 orbits provide the broad BLUE picture.
- Coastwatch and S-300 anchor RED cueing.
- The channel produces long missile fields but shortens reaction time around land masks.
- Visual/FAC gun engagements indicate the screen has allowed excessive closure.



Cover & Concealment

- Open sea gives little physical cover to the convoy.
- Musandam and islands can mask radar and missile seekers.
- RED surface units can emerge late from coastal clutter.
- BLUE substitutes layered defense, emission control, spacing, and standoff for physical cover.



Obstacles

- The Strait itself is the dominant channelizing obstacle.
- Mine uncertainty justifies Devastator and Dextrous leading the passage.
- Overlapping Bastion, S-300, and Pantsir zones constrain maneuver.
- Neutral traffic and restrictive identification requirements limit free fire.



Key Terrain

- Eastern assembly area: organize without coastal exposure.
- Center lane: decisive geographic point and maximum compression.
- Western exit: convoy clearance and transition point.
- Coastwatch/Bastion clusters: functional key terrain for RED's kill chain.
- Carrier recovery box: preserves Tiger flight without committing the carrier.



Avenues of Approach

- BLUE main: MCM-led westbound surface corridor.
- BLUE air: CAP over corridor; strike axis from Al Dhafra; P-8 classification orbit east.
- RED surface: eastbound blocking line from the western narrows.
- RED air: MiGs fix CAP while Fencers approach the auxiliaries.
- RED fires: north-to-south coastal missile axes into a compressed formation.

Organize around protection of the sealift.

BLUE • Corridor Force

30

Recommended functional grouping

SEALIFT	Fort Victoria, John Ericsson, Amelia Earhart, Tidespring, Guadalupe, Cesar Chavez
MCM LEAD	Devastator, Dextrous
AAW SCREEN	Mason, Chosin, Thomas Hudner, Arleigh Burke, Diamond
CLOSE SCREEN	Richmond, Tempest, Stone
CAP	Tiger 1/2; Viper 1/2
STRIKE	Lancer 1/2; Wildcat 1/2
ISR / C2	Sentinel; Broadarrow; Trident
SUPPORT	Shell 1; Al Dhafra; George H.W. Bush outside Strait

RED • Exclusion Force

24

Threat functions

FAC SCREEN	Khanjar, Falakhon, Dagger, Scimitar, Zolfaghar
SURFACE FIRES	IRIS Sahand, IRIS Dena, Tsunami 1/2
COASTAL FIRES	Bastion 1/2/3
POINT DEFENSE	Pantsir 1/2/3
AREA DEFENSE	S-300 Site North
SENSOR	Coastwatch 1
COUNTER-AIR	Fulcrum 1–4
STRIKE	Fencer 1/2; Bandar Abbas support

Phase on events, not hope.

The matrix is a recommended multiplayer control scheme. “H” is convoy movement from the assembly line. The commander may hold a phase until its exit criteria are met.

FUNCTION	PHASE 0 • SET BEFORE H / COMMAND CHECK	PHASE I • CLASSIFY H TO HOSTILE CLASSIFICATION	PHASE II • PENETRATE CORRIDOR ENTRY TO FIRST COORDINATED ATTACK	PHASE III • DEFEAT MASSSED ATTACK THROUGH SURFACE BREAK	PHASE IV • CLEAR SURFACE THREAT BROKEN TO WESTERN EXIT	PHASE V • CONSOLIDATE CONVOY CLEAR / RECOVER FORCE
COMMANDER / C2	Publish control plan. Assign convoy, AAW, surface, air, and strike leads. Confirm pause authority and target-report format.	Build one picture. Require contact ID, bearing/range, confidence, and threat axis before engagement.	Control compression. Hold auxiliaries behind MCM/AAW lead. Declare primary threat axis and reserve shooter.	Fight the salvo. Centralize priorities; decentralize self-defense. Shift fires only after inbound weapons are controlled.	Prevent pursuit. Keep screen between convoy and surviving threats; do not chase north.	Account and report. Units, weapons, damage, goal status, recovery, and campaign carry-forward.
PHASE TRIGGER / DECISION	Go: all players ready; routes and recovery reviewed.	Advance: nine RED surface contacts classified or bounded; CAP established.	Advance: lead MCM reaches narrows or RED initiates coordinated fires.	Advance: six surface kills achieved or remaining surface force cannot reach convoy.	Advance: fifth auxiliary clears decisive sector and no effective salvo is inbound.	Terminate: goals resolved or commander determines further action violates intent.
MCM LEAD	Devastator / Dextrous. Form ahead of convoy; verify both use checked westbound route.	Proceed at formation pace. Report any forced deviation; avoid independent contact pursuit.	Lead through the center lane. If one is lost, survivor becomes lane guide; AAW lead does not pass blindly.	Continue navigation; self-defense only. Do not become the surface action group.	Mark western exit and hand convoy lead to designated escort.	Rejoin support group; report route deviations for map-framework review.
CONVOY	Six auxiliaries. Establish order, speed of slowest unit, and casualty station.	Maintain column/compact formation without overtaking screen. No independent targeting.	Preserve spacing sufficient to avoid one salvo affecting multiple hulls; stay within AAW umbrella.	Continue west unless physically blocked. Damaged ship falls to rear with assigned escort.	Cross western exit in order. Five surviving auxiliaries is mission threshold.	Damage-control and logistics assessment; identify which cargo capability was preserved or lost.
AAW SCREEN	Mason / Chosin / Hudner / Arleigh Burke / Diamond. Establish sectors and reserve channels.	Track MiGs, Fencers, and coastal emitters. Conserve long-range missiles until hostile intent/launch.	Layer shooters ahead, abeam, and astern of convoy. Prioritize leakers threatening auxiliaries.	Priority: inbound weapons → Fencers → missile shooters → MiGs threatening strike/CAP.	Maintain aft guard; do not strip convoy defense to finish retreating contacts.	Report remaining AAW inventory and identify minimum screen for follow-on operations.
CLOSE / SURFACE SCREEN	Richmond / Tempest / Stone. Assign left, right, and stern sectors.	Hold outside FAC direct-fire envelope. Pass classifications to long-range shooters.	Block leakers without outrunning major combatants. Use guns only for self-defense or terminal defense.	Engage damaged/leaking FACs that can still reach convoy; avoid entering the northern coastal-defense pocket.	Cover rear and damaged auxiliaries. Break contact when enemy no longer affects passage.	Reconstitute close screen and report boarding/search capability.
CAP / COUNTER-AIR	Tiger / Viper. Assign high/low blocks and recovery owner. Manually confirm weapons.	Sanitize Fencer approach lanes; keep MiGs separated from strike package and Sentinel.	Commit one element; retain one between threat and convoy. Do not drag CAP over S-300/Pantsir sites.	Kill Fencers before release when possible; otherwise support missile defense and defeat MiG escort.	Reset east of coastal SAM threat; cover convoy until last auxiliary clears.	Tiger recovers to carrier; Viper to Al Dhafra. Report fuel, missiles, and aircraft status.
MARITIME ISR / STRIKE	Broadarrow / Trident. Split search sectors; load Harpoons verified.	Classify surface groups and maintain standoff. Avoid duplicating tracks and weapons.	Target frigates/missile boats first; FACs next. Fire only against identified hostile tracks.	Provide battle-damage assessment before reattack. Prevent waste against already doomed contacts.	Track survivors; attack only if they retain a firing solution on convoy.	Recover to Al Dhafra; report remaining Harpoons and sensor coverage.
SHORE STRIKE	Lancer / Wildcat. Pair shooters, assign primary/alternate nodes, verify manual-control players.	Hold outside S-300/Pantsir envelopes while Sentinel/P-8 refine the picture.	On positive control, disrupt Coastwatch or exposed Bastion first if it directly supports active fires.	Complete three-node requirement while preserving enough weapons for reattack. No non-designated targets.	Terminate shore attack when three nodes are down or convoy defense requires aircraft elsewhere.	Recover Al Dhafra; document exact nodes destroyed for campaign persistence.
ISR / BATTLE MANAGEMENT	Sentinel. Establish orbit and naming convention. Confirm all players share track picture.	Separate air, surface, missile, and coastal tracks. Call first indication of coordinated attack.	Maintain custody through land masking; warn when contacts disappear behind terrain.	Prioritize inbound weapon tracks and surface shooters with unexpended missiles.	Watch for reattack from Bandar Abbas and surviving coastal nodes.	Recover Al Dhafra; preserve track history for after-action review.
TARGET PRIORITY	Pre-assign: Fencers; missile boats/frigates; active Bastions/Coastwatch; leaker FACs.	Do not spend weapons solely to satisfy goals before threat intent is established.	1. Inbound weapons 2. Fencers 3. surface missile shooters.	1. Inbound weapons 2. live shooters 3. three designated nodes 4. goal completion.	Only threats that can still affect convoy passage.	No additional fires unless required for force protection.

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LOGISTICS / RECOVERY	Shell establishes support orbit. Carrier and Al Dhafra availability confirmed.	Monitor fuel states; do not let strike aircraft cross minimum recovery fuel.	Prioritize damaged aircraft and low-fuel CAP. Keep tanker away from threat axis.	Rotate CAP rather than collapse the screen. Divert damaged land-based aircraft to Al Dhafra.	Recover strike first if Winchester; maintain one CAP element until convoy clears.	Full fuel/ammunition/damage accounting; identify next-turn availability.
ROE / CONSTRAINTS	Hostile relationship active. Rehearse positive identification and designated shore-target list.	Track and classify; self-defense always authorized. Avoid neutral or ambiguous contacts.	Engage hostile aircraft, missiles, and attacking surface units. Shore fires require positive control.	No expansion beyond Bastion 1/2/3, S-300 North, and Coastwatch 1.	No pursuit into ports or attacks on Bandar Abbas merely to accumulate damage.	Cease offensive action when corridor is secure and force-protection need ends.
RISK INDICATOR	Unassigned roles, no recovery plan, or conflicting target ownership.	Unknown surface contacts inside standoff range; CAP pulled north toward S-300.	Auxiliaries ahead of AAW screen; MCM bypassed; formation compressed below reaction space.	Multiple inbound axes, depleted long-range SAMs, two auxiliaries damaged, FACs inside gun range.	Screen chases retreating enemy while convoy remains in the narrows.	Unrecovered aircraft or incomplete loss/ammunition accounting.
EXIT CRITERIA	Roles, comms, routes, weapons, recovery, and ROE acknowledged.	Picture stable enough to designate threat axes and shooter assignments.	Convoy enters decisive sector with layered protection intact.	Six surface threats destroyed/neutralized and massed attack defeated.	At least five auxiliaries clear west; no effective attack remains inbound.	Goals adjudicated, units recovered/accounted, campaign state ready to update.

Four moments where the group should slow down and decide.

DP 1 • Commit

Is the recognized picture good enough to move six auxiliaries into the channel, or should the convoy hold east?

DP 2 • Defend or strike

Are Lancer/Wildcat needed against the active coastal kill chain, or must they support the air/surface defense?

DP 3 • Continue or extract

After the first massed salvo, can five auxiliaries still clear with a viable AAW screen?

DP 4 • Terminate

Once the corridor is open, does further pursuit add campaign value or merely create avoidable losses and escalation?

Discord facilitator note. Pause briefly at each decision point. Have the commander state the decision, supporting facts, accepted risk, and next phase trigger. That creates a clean shared record for the campaign AAR and gives every player a common mental model.